

MUST FOR EVERY STUDENT ... FOR ALL COMPETITIVE EXAMS

ENGLISH MADE SIMPLE!

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MODULE - 15



Albeit : *Although/despite the fact that.*

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Example :

Bengaluru weather is quite good, and it is considered a livable city, **albeit** overcrowded.



Albeit : *Although/despite the fact that.*

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Example :
The Bullet Train project is making progress in India, **albeit** rather slowly.



Albeit : *Although/despite the fact that.*

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Example :
The CEO tried hard,
albeit without success.



Albeit : *Although/despite the fact that.*

141

Example :
This laptop looks amazing, **albeit** costly



Although : *Despite the fact that.*

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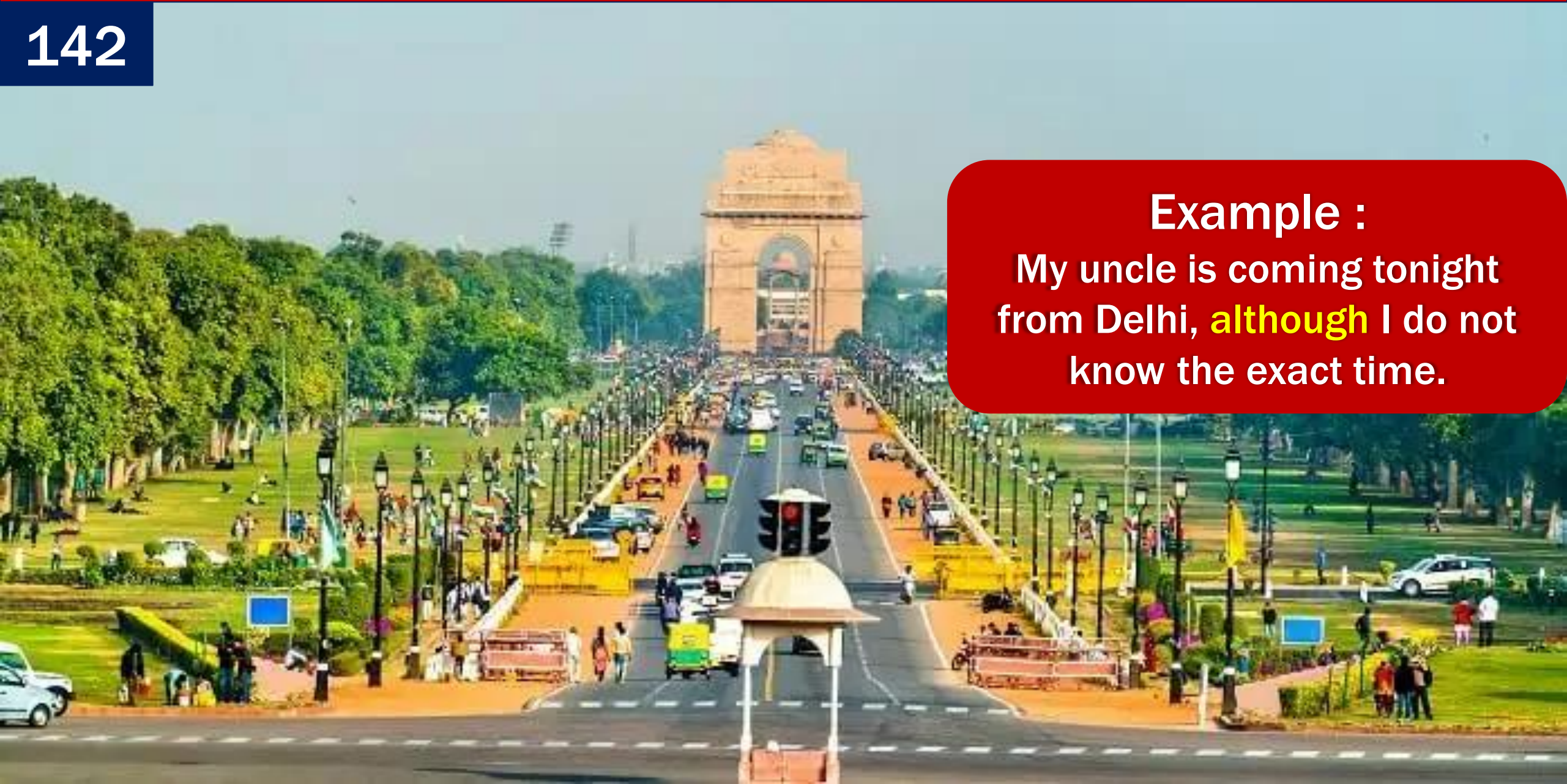


Example :

Raju decided to go to USA,
although his parents are not in
favor of that.

Although : *But*

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Example :
My uncle is coming tonight from Delhi, **although** I do not know the exact time.

Nevertheless : *Despite what has just been said or referred to.*

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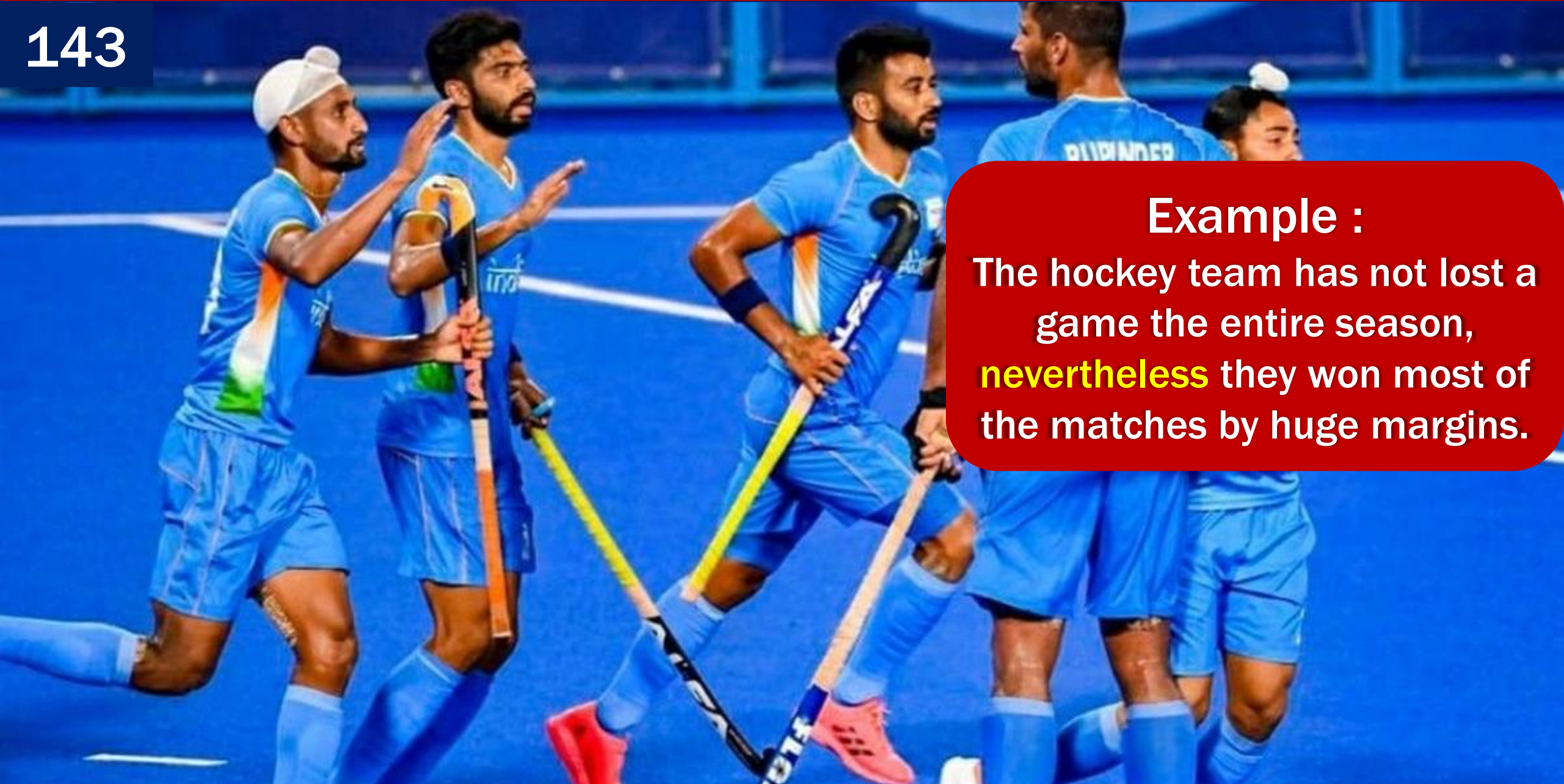


Example :

I knew a lot about the cloud computing, but his talk was quite interesting, **nevertheless**.

Nevertheless : *Despite what has just been said or referred to.*

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Example :

The hockey team has not lost a game the entire season, **nevertheless** they won most of the matches by huge margins.

However : *Despite whatever amount or degree.*

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Example :
The bill is unlikely to be passed in U.S Congress, **however** worthy it is.

However : *Despite whatever amount or degree.*

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Example :

However fast we drive, we are not going to reach Hyderabad in time.



However : *Whatever way you look at.*

144



PAKISTAN

Example :
However one looks at it, the
Pakistani economy is in a
deep mess.

However : *Despite this*

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Mediterranean Sea

LEBANON

JORDAN

EGYPT

SAUDI ARABIA

Gulf of Aqaba

Example :

There may, **however**, be other reasons that we don't know about for the collapse of Lebanese economy.

Morality : *The quality of being right, honest or acceptable.*

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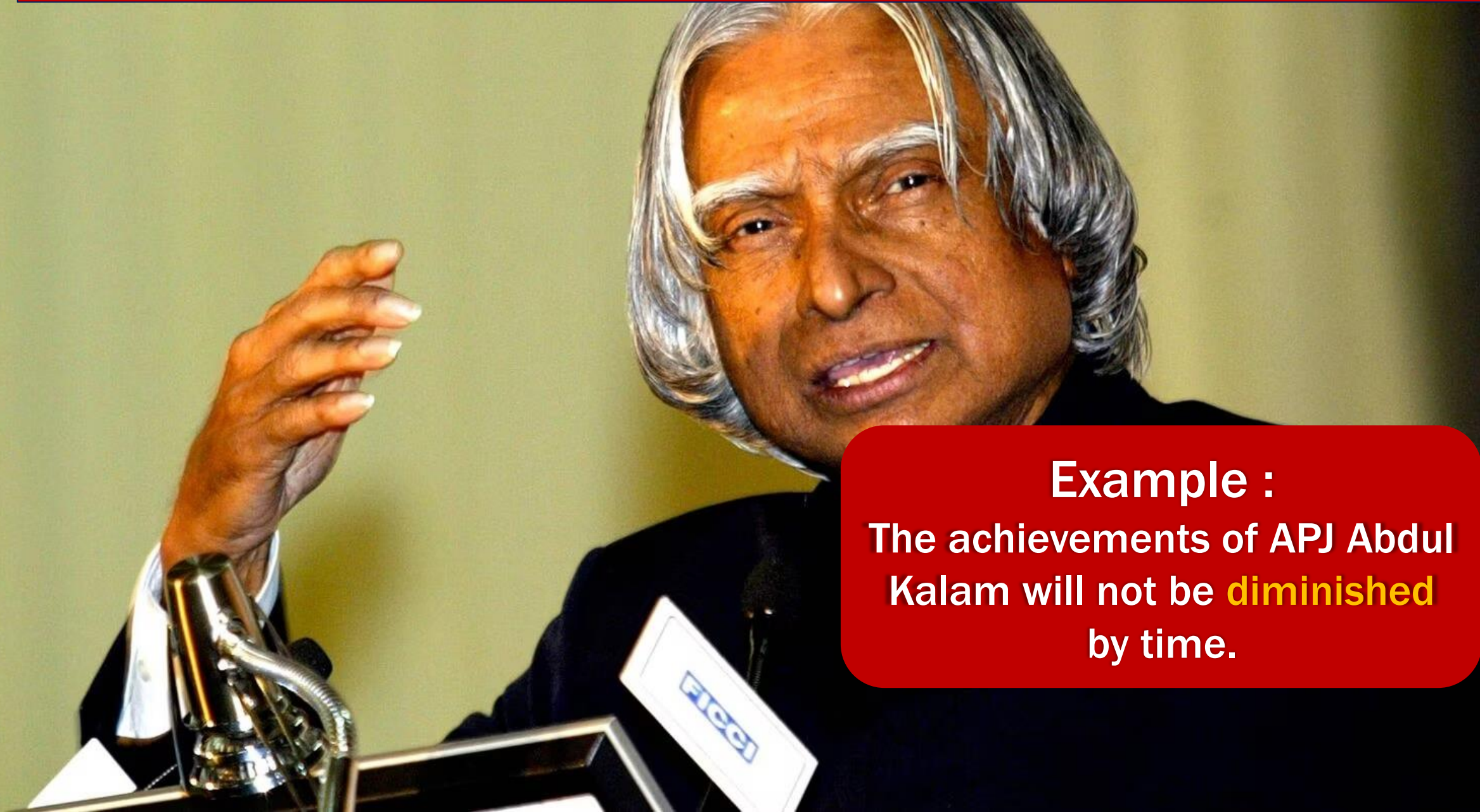


Example :
In general, there is a fall in **morality** in public life.



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Diminish : To reduce in size/importance.



Example :

The achievements of APJ Abdul Kalam will not be **diminished** by time.

Diminish : To reduce in size/importance.

146

Example :

Investors can diversify their holdings in order to **diminish** risk.



Vibrancy : Energetic/exciting/full of enthusiasm.

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Example :
Some of the South
Indian cities like Hyderabad,
Bengaluru are **vibrant**,
whereas Eastern cities are not.



Vibrancy : The quality of being bright and strong.

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HDR

Example :

The **vibrancy** of the colours enhances the picture quality.



Google TV

X1

4K Processor



Ok Google

Vibrancy : The quality of being bright and strong.

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Example :
Foreign dignitaries visiting India are struck by the **vibrancy** of the Indian economy.

Hark back : To remember something from the past.

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Example :
Majority of the Indian villages are well developed, whereas a few of them are highly underdeveloped and these **harks back** to the British era.

Harks back to something : If someone harks back to something in the past, they talk about it again and again often in a way that annoys other people.

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Example :

He is always **harking back** to the old movies and saying how things were better at that point of time.

PASSAGE - 7



21-09-2023

UNDOING REFORM

Shift to old pension scheme is fiscally imprudent. In run-up to polls, parties must be mindful of long-term implications

THE SHIFT TO the National Pension System in the 2000s was a major, hard-won fiscal reform. The move was supported by parties across the political spectrum. The process was initiated by the NDA under then Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, and the UPA government continued with it. Over time, most states shifted to the NPS, with only West Bengal and Tamil Nadu staying with the old pension scheme. However, it would now seem that the broad political consensus that led to this fiscally prudent decision has frayed. Several states such as Rajasthan, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Punjab and Himachal Pradesh, ruled by parties who are in opposition to the BJP at the Centre, have announced a shift back to the old pension scheme. Such decisions, driven by political motives, will benefit only a small section of the electorate, and will have adverse long-term fiscal consequences. As a new study by economists at the Reserve Bank of India says, this shift "will be a major step backwards undermining the benefits of past fiscal reforms and compromising the interest of future generations".

Unlike the NPS which is a defined contribution scheme, the old pension scheme is a defined benefit scheme. In this framework, the benefits accruing to employees are marked out — for state government employees, the pension is fixed at 50 per cent of the last drawn salary. This places a significant fiscal burden on the government. As per the RBI study, the burden of switching back to this unfunded scheme would be roughly 4.5 times that of the NPS, "with the additional burden reaching 0.9 per cent of GDP annually by 2060". Pensions already account for a sizeable share of state expenditure allocation. In 2022-23, states had allocated Rs 4.63 lakh crore for pensions, up from Rs 3.45 lakh crore in 2019-20. For all states and Union Territories, the allocations to pension were pegged at 11.8 per cent of the revenue expenditure. For some states it was significantly higher — for Uttar Pradesh it was 16.9 per cent, for Kerala 17.1 per cent, and for Himachal Pradesh 19.3 per cent.

While the move to the old pension scheme may lead to some gains in the short term, over time, the costs will be far greater, constricting the fiscal space available to the state governments. According to the study, the shift can "increase their fiscal stress to unsustainable levels in the medium to long-term". And as the pension outgo increases, it "may compel the states to cut down their capital expenditure, affecting the long term growth prospects of the economy." In the run-up to the national elections, while there may be a temptation to announce such populist measures, political parties of all ideological hues must shun such policies whose harmful effects will return to haunt.

UNDOING REFORM

Shift to old pension scheme is fiscally imprudent. In run-up to polls, political parties must be mindful of long-term implications

The shift to the National Pension System in the 2000s was a major, **hard-won** fiscal reform. The move was supported by parties across the political **spectrum**. The process was **initiated** by the NDA under then Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, and the UPA government continued with it. Over time, most states shifted to the NPS, with only West Bengal and Tamil Nadu staying with the old pension scheme. **However**, it would now seem that the broad political consensus that led to this fiscally prudent decision has **frayed**.

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